

TAB 22



Board of Education Report

[Return to Order of Business](#)

File #: Res-016-23/24, **Version:** 1

Ms. Ortiz Franklin - Celebrating Read LA! Day (Res-016-23/24) (Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, Early literacy is a fundamental building block of a child's education, developing strong reading and comprehension skills, leading to improved communication, critical thinking, and problem-solving abilities and a key determinant of future academic and life success;

Whereas, According to the 2023 California Smarter Balanced assessment results, nearly 60% of all LAUSD third grade students did not meet state standards in English Language Arts; 67% of Latino/x/e students, 73% of Black students, 91% of English Learners, and 68% of economically disadvantaged students in third grade did not meet these standards;

Whereas, Early literacy begins at birth, therefore supporting and equipping families and caregivers in the early years are essential to nurture young children's language development, cognitive and executive function skills and other critical early childhood milestones;

Whereas, Structured literacy instruction in the early grades, following the Science of Reading (SoR), including effective SoR practices for English Learners/Emergent Bilinguals as outlined in the Joint Statement by the Reading League and National Committee for Effective Literacy, has proven to be the most effective way to help children learn to read;

Whereas, All teachers deserve to be provided with science-aligned professional development and ongoing supports to ensure their students meet or exceed state standards in English Language Arts;

Whereas, Children's access to high quality early learning environments, enriching summers, tutoring supports, and literacy resources in homes, schools, and communities can reduce educational disparities and bridge opportunity and achievement gaps; and

Whereas, Families In Schools and its coalition partners will launch the Read LA!: *Literacy & Justice for All* campaign on November 14, 2023, mobilizing all of Los Angeles to elevate and prioritize early literacy and work to reverse our literacy crisis, giving every child the right to read; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Board of Education of the Los Angeles Unified School District hereby proclaims November 14 as "Read LA Day" and encourages all Los Angeles leaders and stakeholders, including early education providers, schools, parents, civic leaders, community organizations, policymakers, and funders to recognize and prioritize early literacy as a cornerstone of our children's educational journey.